

held in contempt by those who make it. It is like a woman's heart that is too easily won or a prize that is too easily awarded. It loses value.

It also takes time to learn how to keep money. Money earned over a long time comes with valuable lessons attached. You learn how to manage it. How to invest it. How not to waste it. Often, you are loath to spend it. Failure to learn those lessons is usually fatal to a family's wealth.

That's also why "new money" tends to have such a tinny look to it. You expect it to wear out fast. Old Money, however, has a more solid look—like it might last forever.

As we will say more than once in the book, it takes more than money to be really wealthy.

Let's look in greater detail at the different forms of capital that families possess to better understand how to hold on to our wealth over the long term.

HUMAN CAPITAL

Human capital is typically described as the knowledge, ability, and experience that individual family members possess. But it's much more than that. It's also a family's emotional stability, its culture, its willingness to take risks, its willingness to work hard and to forgo immediate gratification, its ability to get along and pull together to protect itself, as well as to achieve common goals.

Focus on the attributes of the individuals in your family unit for a moment. . . . There are the physical attributes: The family members are short. They are tall. They are good looking. They are homely.

There are mental attributes: They are smart. They are dumb.

Then there are the personalities: They are honest. They are liars. They are trustworthy. They are hard working. Some are healthy; some are sickly.

The individual members of your family and their unique, or not so unique, characteristics are what make up the human capital of the family.

Much of what constitutes a family's human capital is beyond our reach. People are born with certain features. Many of them you can't do anything about. They are what they are. (Note that you can change a family's human